Day 21 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Emergence of Leaders I: Gandhi, Nehru, Bose, Ambedkar

READING MATERIAL

First of two 'Emergence of Leaders' topics. Real exam evidence favors specific, checkable facts (thesis titles, exact dates, party foundings, direct quotes) over general biography — and includes at least one genuine authorship trap to watch for.

Q: Real exam: What was the title of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's economics thesis?
A: "The Problem of the Rupee" (his doctoral thesis, examining India's currency/monetary system under British rule).

Q: Real exam (trap): Who actually authored/moved the 'Objective Resolution' in the Constituent Assembly — is it Dr. B.R. Ambedkar?
A: No — it was Jawaharlal Nehru, not Ambedkar, who moved the Objective Resolution (adopted 22 January 1947), which later became the basis for the Constitution's Preamble. Ambedkar's major constitutional role was instead as Chairman of the Drafting Committee.

Q: Real exam: Who said, 'Great Leaders have something in them which inspires a whole people and makes them do great deeds'?
A: Jawaharlal Nehru.

Q: Real exam: When was Subhas Chandra Bose born, and which party did he found?
A: 23 January 1897. He founded the Forward Bloc Party (a left-leaning party within/breaking from Congress).

Q: Real exam: What did Mahatma Gandhi call the Thirukkural?
A: He referred to it as 'Tamil's sacred book' (echoing similar reverence expressed by other figures like Bishop Caldwell about Tamil literature's civilizational depth).

Q: What were Gandhi's major movements, in order?
A: Champaran Satyagraha (1917, his first major movement in India) → Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-22) → Civil Disobedience Movement / Dandi Salt March (1930) → Quit India Movement (1942).

Q: What was Nehru's role after independence, and what is his most famous speech called?
A: India's first Prime Minister (1947-1964). His most famous speech, delivered on the eve of independence (14-15 August 1947), is known as 'Tryst with Destiny'.

Q: What was Subhas Chandra Bose's most famous call to action, and what military force did he lead?
A: "Give me blood, and I will give you freedom" (Tum Mujhe Khoon Do, Main Tumhe Azadi Doonga). He led the Indian National Army (INA / Azad Hind Fauj).

Q: What was Ambedkar's principal constitutional role, and what else is he known for?
A: Chairman of the Constitution's Drafting Committee — often called the 'Father/Architect of the Indian Constitution'. He's also known for leading the Dalit rights movement and (later in life) his conversion to Buddhism.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's doctoral thesis was titled:

A. Annihilation of Caste
B. The Problem of the Rupee ✓
C. States and Minorities
D. Who Were the Shudras?

Explanation: "The Problem of the Rupee." [hard, question-bank-2024]

2. The 'Objective Resolution', later forming the basis of the Constitution's Preamble, was moved in the Constituent Assembly by:

A. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
B. Jawaharlal Nehru ✓
C. Rajendra Prasad
D. Sardar Patel

Explanation: Jawaharlal Nehru — not Ambedkar, a common trap. [hard, question-bank-2025]

3. Subhas Chandra Bose was born on:

A. January 23, 1897 ✓

B. January 23, 1891

C. January 26, 1901

D. January 23, 1895

Explanation: 23 January 1897. [medium, question-bank-2024]

4. Subhas Chandra Bose founded which political party?

A. Swaraj Party

B. Gadar Party

C. Forward Bloc ✓

D. Swatantra Party

Explanation: Forward Bloc. [medium, question-bank-2022]

5. Gandhi's first major Satyagraha movement IN India (before later national movements) was the:

A. Champaran Satyagraha ✓

B. Dandi Salt March

C. Quit India Movement

D. Non-Cooperation Movement

Explanation: Champaran Satyagraha (1917). [medium, authored]

6. Nehru's famous speech on the eve of independence is known as:

A. Quit India

B. Tryst with Destiny ✓

C. Do or Die

D. Inquilab Zindabad

Explanation: "Tryst with Destiny." [easy, authored]

7. "Give me blood, and I will give you freedom" is most associated with:

A. Mahatma Gandhi

B. Subhas Chandra Bose ✓

C. Bhagat Singh

D. Jawaharlal Nehru

Explanation: Subhas Chandra Bose. [easy, authored]

8. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's principal role in the Constituent Assembly was:

A. President of the Constituent Assembly

B. Chairman of the Drafting Committee ✓

C. Mover of the Objective Resolution

D. First Speaker of the Lok Sabha

Explanation: Chairman of the Drafting Committee. [medium, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Ratio and Proportion

READING MATERIAL

Ratio & Proportion is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills, and real exam evidence shows it's tested through several distinct shapes, not just 'simplify this ratio'. Learn each shape as its own method.

Q: Real exam (2025): A man spends Rs.500 buying 12 tables and chairs. One table costs Rs.50, one chair costs Rs.40. Find the ratio of chairs to tables purchased.

A: Let tables=t, chairs=c. t+c=12 and 50t+40c=500 (i.e. 5t+4c=50). Substitute t=12−c: 5(12−c)+4c=50 → 60−5c+4c=50 → c=10, so t=2. Ratio chairs:tables = 10:2 = 5:1.

Q: Method — combining two ratios that share a common term: If a:b=3:5 and b:c=7:8, find a:c.

A: To chain two ratios, scale each so the SHARED term (b) matches in both. Here b is 5 in the first ratio and 7 in the second — LCM(5,7)=35. Scale a:b=3:5 by ×7 → a:b=21:35. Scale b:c=7:8 by ×5 → b:c=35:40. Now a:b:c = 21:35:40, so a:c = 21:40.

Q: Method — continued proportion (three terms in one ratio): If a/10 = b/15 = c/20, find a:b:c.

A: All three fractions equal the same constant, so a:b:c is simply 10:15:20, which reduces to 2:3:4 (dividing by the HCF, 5).

Q: Method — chaining two ratios via a shared term: If A:B=3:4 and B:C=8:9, find A:C.

A: B is 4 in the first ratio and 8 in the second — scale the first ratio so B matches: multiply A:B=3:4 by 2 to get A:B=6:8. Now both ratios share B=8: A:B:C = 6:8:9. So A:C = 6:9 = 2:3.

Q: Method — mixture/alloy adjustment (add a pure ingredient to shift a ratio): A mixture of 60 L has acid:water = 2:1. How much water must be added to make the ratio 1:2?

A: Acid:water = 2:1 in 60L means acid=40L, water=20L. We're only adding water (acid stays at 40L). We want acid:water = 1:2, i.e. water = 2×acid = 80L. Water to add = 80−20 = 60L.

Q: Method — simplest form of an age ratio: Azhagan is 50 years old, his son is 10. What is the simplest ratio of their ages?

A: 50:10 reduces (divide both by 10) to 5:1.

Q: Method — finding an unknown in a proportion (cross-multiplication): If the numbers 2, 5, x, 20 (in that order) are in proportion, find x.

A: In proportion, 2:5 = x:20, so 2×20 = 5×x → 40 = 5x → x = 8. (General rule: in a:b=c:d, a×d = b×c.)

Q: Method — the '4th proportional': Find the 4th proportional to 4, 16, and 7.

A: The 4th proportional x satisfies 4:16 = 7:x → 4x = 16×7 = 112 → x = 28.

Q: Method — splitting a total using a 3-part ratio and a given average: Three numbers are in ratio 3:5:7 and their average is 60. Find the smallest number.

A: Average of 60 over 3 numbers means their total = 180. Split 180 in ratio 3:5:7 (15 parts total): each part = 180/15 = 12. Smallest = 3×12 = 36.

Q: Method — 'duplicate ratio' (squaring a ratio): What is the duplicate ratio of 2:7?

A: The duplicate ratio of a:b is $a^2:b^2$. So the duplicate ratio of 2:7 is 4:49.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A woman spends Rs.620 buying 14 pens and notebooks. One pen costs Rs.30, one notebook costs Rs.50. Find the ratio of notebooks to pens purchased.

A. 2:5

B. 5:2 ✓

C. 3:4

D. 4:3

Explanation: p+n=14; 30p+50n=620 → 3p+5n=62. Substitute p=14−n: 3(14−n)+5n=62 → 42+2n=62 → n=10, p=4. Ratio notebooks:pens = 10:4 = 5:2. [hard, authored]

2. If x/8 = y/12 = z/20, find x:y:z in lowest terms.

A. 2:3:5 ✓

B. 8:12:20

C. 4:6:10

D. 1:2:3

Explanation: x:y:z = 8:12:20, which reduces (divide by HCF=4) to 2:3:5. [easy, authored]

3. If P:Q = 2:3 and Q:R = 9:10, find P:R.

A. 3:5 ✓

B. 2:5

C. 3:10

D. 9:20

Explanation: Scale P:Q=2:3 by 3 to get P:Q=6:9, matching Q=9 from Q:R=9:10. So P:Q:R=6:9:10, giving P:R=6:10=3:5. [medium, authored]

4. A 40 L mixture has milk:water = 3:1. How much water must be added to change the ratio to 3:2?

A. 5 L

B. 10 L ✓

C. 8 L

D. 6 L

Explanation: Milk:water=3:1 in 40L means milk=30L, water=10L. Milk stays fixed; we want water=(2/3)×milk=(2/3)×30=20L. Water to add = 20−10 = 10 L. [hard, authored]

5. If 5, 8, x, 24 are in proportion, find x.

A. 12.5

B. 15 ✓

C. 16

D. 20

Explanation: 5:8 = x:24 → 5×24=8x → 120=8x → x=15. [easy, authored]

6. Find the 4th proportional to 3, 12, and 9.

A. 27

B. 36 ✓

C. 30

D. 33

Explanation: 3:12 = 9:x → 3x = 12×9 = 108 → x = 36. [easy, authored]

7. Three numbers are in the ratio 2:3:4 and their average is 45. Find the largest number.

A. 40

B. 50

C. 60 ✓

D. 45

Explanation: Average 45 over 3 numbers means total=135. 9 parts total, each part=15. Largest = 4×15=60. [medium, authored]

8. What is the duplicate ratio of 3:5?

A. 6:10

B. 9:25 ✓

C. 9:10

D. 3:25

Explanation: Duplicate ratio = square each term: $3^2:5^2$ = 9:25. [easy, authored]

9. A sum of Rs.450 is divided among 100 boys and girls, each boy getting Rs.5.10 and each girl Rs.3.60. Find the number of girls.

A. 20

B. 30

C. 40 ✓

D. 50

Explanation: Let girls=g, boys=100−g. 3.6g + 5.1(100−g) = 450 → 3.6g+510−5.1g=450 → −1.5g=−60 → g=40. [hard, authored]

10. A father's age (40) to his daughter's age (8) — what is the simplest ratio?

A. 5:1 ✓

B. 8:1

C. 4:1

D. 10:1

Explanation: 40:8 reduces (÷8) to 5:1. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Star" — Jane Taylor

READING MATERIAL

The classic nursery rhyme "Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star", attributed in this syllabus to its original author, Jane Taylor. Real coaching-site evidence tests the well-known simile and structural facts.

Q: Who wrote "The Star" (better known as "Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star")?
A: Jane Taylor.

Q: What is the poem's rhyme scheme?
A: AABB.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Like a diamond in the sky."
A: Simile — directly compares the star's twinkle to a diamond using 'like'.

Q: What does "twinkle" mean?
A: To shine with a flickering light.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "You never shut your eye."
A: Personification — the star is given the human attribute of having an 'eye' that it keeps open (i.e., it doesn't 'sleep', continuing to shine).

Q: What happens, per the poem, when "the blazing sun is gone"?
A: The star begins to shine (i.e., the star becomes visible once daylight fades).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Star" was written by:

A. Emily Dickinson

B. Robert Louis Stevenson

C. Jane Taylor ✓

D. William Wordsworth

Explanation: Jane Taylor. [easy, web-research]

2. What is the rhyme scheme of "The Star"?

A. ABAB

B. AABB ✓

C. ABCD

D. ABCA

Explanation: AABB. [medium, web-research]

3. "Like a diamond in the sky" is an example of:

A. Metaphor

B. Hyperbole

C. Simile ✓

D. Irony

Explanation: Simile — uses 'like'. [easy, web-research]

4. In the poem, "twinkle" means:

A. Float slowly

B. Shine with a flickering light ✓

C. Jump or fly

D. Melt and disappear

Explanation: Shine with a flickering light. [easy, web-research]

5. "You never shut your eye" uses which figure of speech?

A. Hyperbole

B. Simile

C. Personification ✓

D. Metaphor

Explanation: Personification — the star given a human 'eye'. [medium, web-research]

6. What happens when "the blazing sun is gone", per the poem?

A. The star stops twinkling

B. The sky becomes red

C. The star begins to shine ✓

D. The moon rises

Explanation: The star begins to shine. [medium, web-research]